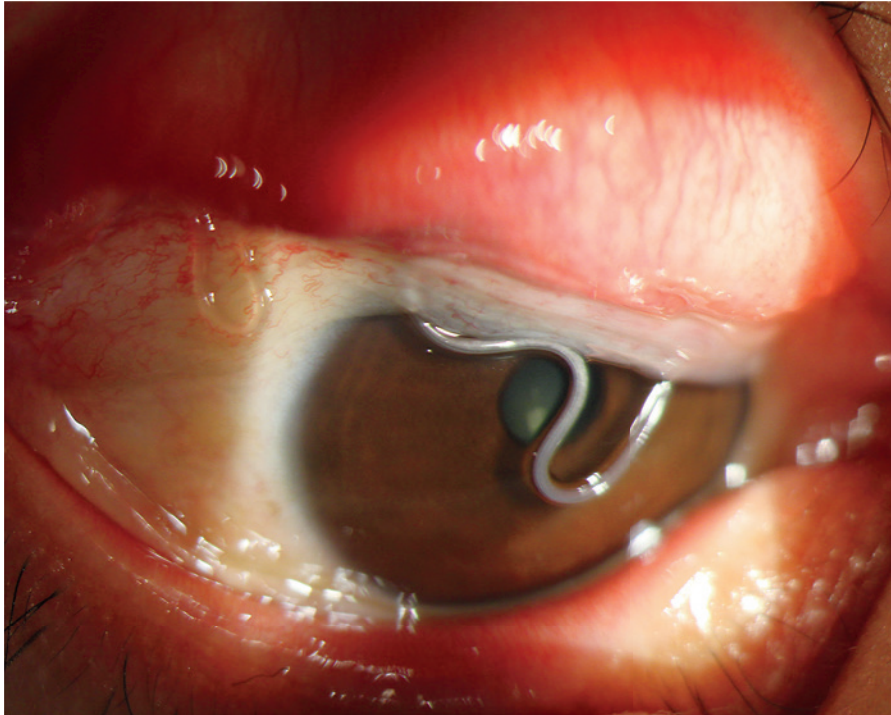


IMAGES IN CLINICAL MEDICINE

Stephanie V. Sherman, M.D., *Editor*

Ocular Thelaziasis



A 34-YEAR-OLD MAN PRESENTED TO THE OPHTHALMOLOGY CLINIC AND reported having the sensation of a foreign body and itching in his right eye. He had no known medical history, and he lived on a farm with his dog. Examination with slit-lamp microscopy showed two live worms beneath the upper eyelid. A topical anesthetic was administered, and the worms were removed with the use of a fine forcep (video). The worms were sent to the university parasitology laboratory for examination and were identified as *Thelazia callipaeda*. A diagnosis of ocular thelaziasis was made. *T. callipaeda*, a parasitic worm that is carried and transmitted by drosophilid flies, feeds on eye secretions and deposits larvae in the eyes of the definitive host, typically a dog but occasionally a human. At follow-up 1 month after the worms had been removed, the pruritus had resolved and the patient no longer had the sensation of a foreign body in his eye. He has not reported recurrence.

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A video is
available at
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